An Archer's Affirmations

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/63347134.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Bow & Mermista (She-Ra), Bow & Glimmer (She-Ra)

Characters:
Bow (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra)

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POV Bow (She-Ra), Bow Is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Bow Needs a Hug (She-Ra), War, Self-Doubt, Guilt, Mentioned Adora (She-Ra), Mentioned Catra (She-Ra), Having Faith, Trust

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by Utter_Immolation

Summary

Bow is ruminating on a recent injury and his role in the war. Mermista listens.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

“Ugh. So like…what's up with you?”

Bow startled, a tiny screwdriver slipping through his fingers. “Mermista! Hey, I didn't know you were coming?”

The Sea Princess dramatically rolled her eyes. “Ugh. Meeting with the Queen, but she's like, busy, so I guess I'm waiting. Whatever. It's better than having to listen to *another* shanty on the boat.”

Bow smiled as he stooped, searching for his tool. “Considering I don't hear singing, I'm guessing Sea Hawk damaged the boat again?”

Mermista dramatically slumped down into a nearby chair. “I'm almost glad. And like, super confused. How can he sail rings around a kraken but almost dies slamming us into a cliffside?”

Bow quietly cheered as he found his screwdriver, halfway under his own chair. “That's Sea Hawk for you. He's eccentric, but I'd trust no one else on the water.”

“Whatever,” Mermista scoffs and Bow pretends he doesn't see the fond smile that crosses her face. “So like, how are you? Heard you got hurt.”

He closes his eyes, carefully setting the tool down. “Yeah, I…it wasn't fun. Adora healed me.”

“Well, that's new “

“Yeah. Yeah, I—” The memories, half blurred and overly bright and burning, flicker on the edge of his mind. “I hope she doesn't have to do it again.”

Mermista half-gazed at him, her lazy squint belying the sharp, attentive glint in her eyes. “Well duh. Who wants to get blown up again?” She focused on his poorly concealed grimace, and shifted upright, dropping the act. “But that's not the only thing is it?”

“Do you know *how* Adora heals people?”

“I'd figured there'd be, like, a light show involved.”

Bow's lips twist into a smile lacking any form of humor. “She takes their injuries, wounds, *diseases* , into herself.”

Mermista blinked, absorbed that. “Wow. Okay. That's…you had a disease?”

“No. The local infirmary did though.”

“Huh. And Catra?”

“Dragged her out by the ear, yelling the whole time.” Bow grimaced again. “She can heal herself, but when she got dragged up to the castle, the amount of people she'd healed…well, she was leaking a lot.”

“Ew.”

“Yeah. So Adora is in the metaphorical doghouse again. Catra is mad at her and Angella has to keep turning away citizens who want to get healed by ‘the She-Ra’. Glimmer keeps talking about invading the Fright Zone to get or destroy their ‘Adorapaste’. No one thinks that's a good idea so now Glimmer is mad at Catra, Adora and Angella.”

“And you.”

The Techmaster of Brightmoon turned his attention back to his project, a Horde communicator. Both Adora and Catra had stressed the need to keep Rebellion's finger on the Horde communication pulse and after disabling the tracking system, Bow was trying to figure out a way to not only keep it online and connected to the Horde network but replicate it, providing not only information to Rebels in the field of Force Captain orders and locations but their own compact communication. His pads were incredibly useful, he knew, but not everyone could pop a squat to

input a password and yell at the screen for reinforcements while under fire. “And me.”

Mermista lazily waved her hand. “She'll get over it. You're her best friend.”

“I hope so. The war is getting to her. She's even been visiting Aunt Casta more. If she's willing to put up with Casta trying to shove her into another sweater and feed her fudge so often, Brightmoon must be really stressing her out.”

“Well, no one expected the really, really, *really* annoyingly long war to be wrapped up quickly.”

But she had, Bow reflected. At least a little. So had he. She-Ra had returned. Catra joined. Shadow Weaver died. And Hordak had yet to be seen. For once the Rebellion was winning. For once it felt like they were rooting out the rot and healing instead of just slowly wasting away as the Horde nipped and burned and carved at their borders.

And then…Entrapta. Bigger, stronger, tougher robots, killing indiscriminately, self-repairing, highly adaptable. Adorapaste, letting the soldiers return to the field again and again. Stronger armor, more powerful weapons. Whispers of something else, a Weapon X.

Grizzlor. Bigger, stronger, crueler. Killing sadistically. Whispers, stories of villages or towns where their inhabitants were burned in their homes, run over by tanks, ripped apart by black-armored soldiers wielding guns with bullets that shredded and exploded on contact. People running for hours, days and being hunted by man with a metal arm all the while. Some torn apart and *eaten* , others tortured for hours.

The landscape of the war had changed, slowly, inevitably. How naive they had been, to think victory would crawl into their laps because they held a few new cards.

(In his darkest moments, Bow blamed himself. He was the one that had been captured first. Glimmer had gotten hurt and captured trying to save him. He was the reason Adora lost her memories and became something *other* , the reason Entrapta got left behind. The reason for the Horde re-creating Grizzlor, to fight something, someone, who should have been allowed to do something with her life other than remaining a soldier under a new banner and having the hopes of thousands laid upon her shoulders. He was the reason that they'd found the sword at all, and the reason all their lives had been ruined.)

“Hey.” Mermista poked him with an outstretched foot. “We're going to win in the end, right?”

Bow grinned. The Rebels had composed a song of liberty and… well, rebellion not long after the Battle of Brightmoon. It made his weary heart sour. *We're on the edge of greatness…*

“Right.” He exhaled a breath and did his best to release his fears, doubts and concerns along with it. “We're the Alliance. And we're going to win in the end, one way or another.” He glanced at the clock. “Aren't you late for your meeting?”

Mermista languidly got to her feet with a smoothness that one wouldn't think she'd possess out of water. “I like to think that the party doesn't start ‘till I walk in.”

“A diplomacy meeting is a party?”

“When I'm involved? *Everything* is a party.” A smirk and a hair flip was her farewell as she sashayed out the door. Bow burst into full on laughter, the shadows weighing on his mind finally dispersing.

“What's so funny?” Glimmer asked, teleporting into the room in a blazing flurry of sparkles.

He beamed at his long time friend. Glimmer was keeping secrets. The war was fraying them apsrt. But it also brought them together. Let them discover new strength. New friends. And sometimes, regardless of doubt, regardless of what life threw at you, you had to put faith in the old.

“Well, it starts like this…"

End Notes

As always please read and review. Updates to the series might be even slower than usual as I am participating in this year's SPOP Big Bang (unless the muse attacks me again)!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!